SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

31 May 2022 · Shift 2

78 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 22 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 24 questions

Q.1

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. She will be / write her / examination by this / time tomorrow.

(A) examination by this
(B) time tomorrow
(C) She will be
(D) write her

Q.2

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Something that is pertaining to controversy

(A) Poignancy
(B) laudatory
(C) Putative
(D) Polemical

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The children sat _____ the tables instead of the chairs.

(A) above
(B) near
(C) on
(D) in

Q.4

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person as a source of intellectual light or moral inspiration

(A) Lurch
(B) Luminary
(C) Luminaire
(D) Lunette

Q.5

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Impudent

(A) Insolent
(B) Confident
(C) Triumphant
(D) Polite

Q.6

Complete the sentence with an appropriate synonym of the word mentioned in the bracket. Watching the setting sun and the _____ (tranquil) surface of the water relaxes my mind.

(A) calm
(B) unsettled
(C) moving
(D) roaring

Q.7

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word

(A) Wit
(B) Witch
(C) Wish
(D) Whipe

Q.8

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Wisedom
(B) Freedom
(C) Boredom
(D) Kingdom

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We love to go to the ____.

(A) sea
(B) she
(C) saw
(D) see

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To pay lip service

(A) To express loyalty, respect, or support for something insincerely
(B) To face a risk
(C) To pretend to be very old
(D) To ignore what someone is saying

Q.11

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. Rhea and Heena are both great dancers, “but Rhea is the best.”

(A) but Rhea is one of the best
(B) but Rhea is better
(C) and yet both of are equally good at it
(D) but Rhea is good

Q.12

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. In the theatre, the audience threw flowers on the screen.

(A) In the theatre, flowers were thrown by the audience.
(B) In the theatre, flowers had been thrown by the audience.
(C) In the theatre, flowers was thrown by the audience.
(D) In the theatre, flowers are thrown by the audience.

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined part in the given sentence. This rule is “necesary” to maintain discipline.

(A) nacessary
(B) necessery
(C) necessary
(D) neccessary

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. William Shakespeare and Christopher Marlowe, the two great playwrights of the Elizabethan era, were “living in the same time period.”

(A) Chauvinists
(B) Cosmopolitans
(C) Contemporaries
(D) Cynics

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Judicious

(A) Modest
(B) Reserved
(C) Foolish
(D) Authoritative

Q.17

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Every dog has his day

(A) Every dog is treated well
(B) Celebration of dogs as man's best friend
(C) Everyone has good luck or success at a point of time
(D) Dogs are faithful animals

Q.18

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Very carefully I _____ the tree I have referred to, and avoiding contact with the creepers, the upper _____ and leaves of which might have been visible from where the tiger was lying, I climbed to the fork, where I had a comfortable seat and perfect _____.

(A) stalled, roots, visibility
(B) starved, stem, disclosure
(C) stormed, fruits, revelation
(D) stalked, tendrils, concealment

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Come about

(A) To happen
(B) To explode
(C) To support
(D) To deduce

Q.20

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. The Taj Mahal's history is also one of the world's greatest love stories known to everyone. B. She was the neice of Meherunissa who was married to Prince Salim (later the Empress Nur Jahan.) C. It all started in 1607, when Mughal Prince Khurram, first laid eyes on the lovely Arjumand Banu Begum. D. Khurram, the son of Emperor Jahangir, voiced his wish to marry Arjumand, and their marriage was celebrated with great pomp.

(A) ACBD
(B) ACDB
(C) BACD
(D) ABCD

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1) _____ that comes out of the story The Grasshopper and the Ant has to be subtly put to the children in such a way (2) _____ they realise the worth of hard work, the pleasures of hard work and the comfort it offers. Laziness, which is a (3) _____ trait here, should be discouraged, (4) _____ emphasizing on the (5) _____ note which is hard work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) value
(B) enjoyment
(C) morals
(D) ending

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1) _____ that comes out of the story The Grasshopper and the Ant has to be subtly put to the children in such a way (2) _____ they realise the worth of hard work, the pleasures of hard work and the comfort it offers. Laziness, which is a (3) _____ trait here, should be discouraged, (4) _____ emphasizing on the (5) _____ note which is hard work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) that
(B) who
(C) whom
(D) which

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1) _____ that comes out of the story The Grasshopper and the Ant has to be subtly put to the children in such a way (2) _____ they realise the worth of hard work, the pleasures of hard work and the comfort it offers. Laziness, which is a (3) _____ trait here, should be discouraged, (4) _____ emphasizing on the (5) _____ note which is hard work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3

(A) pleasant
(B) positive
(C) horrible
(D) negative

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1) _____ that comes out of the story The Grasshopper and the Ant has to be subtly put to the children in such a way (2) _____ they realise the worth of hard work, the pleasures of hard work and the comfort it offers. Laziness, which is a (3) _____ trait here, should be discouraged, (4) _____ emphasizing on the (5) _____ note which is hard work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) yet
(B) thus
(C) but
(D) while

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1) _____ that comes out of the story The Grasshopper and the Ant has to be subtly put to the children in such a way (2) _____ they realise the worth of hard work, the pleasures of hard work and the comfort it offers. Laziness, which is a (3) _____ trait here, should be discouraged, (4) _____ emphasizing on the (5) _____ note which is hard work.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) positive
(B) important
(C) essential
(D) critical

General Intelligence 17 questions

Q.1

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 25*5*10*2*4*3

(A) −,+,÷,×,=
(B) ×, ÷,−,+, =
(C) ÷,×,+,−, =
(D) ÷,−,+,×, =

Q.2

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 7 : 392
(B) 9 : 810
(C) 15 : 3150
(D) 12 : 1872

Q.3

Three statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All apples are bananas. All grapes are bananas. All bananas are nuts. Conclusions: I. All apples are nuts. II. All grapes are nuts. III. No nuts are bananas.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Only conclusions I and III follow
(C) Only conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.5

Which letter cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? XYZA, YACE,?, AEIM, BGLQ

(A) ZCFI
(B) ZCIF
(C) ZCDE
(D) ZCEF

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'SCHOOL' is written as 'TDIPPM' and 'COLLEGE' is written as 'DPMMFHF'. How will 'UNIVERSITY' be written in that language?

(A) VJOWSFTJUZ
(B) VOJFWSTJUZ
(C) VOJWJFSTUZ
(D) VOJWFSTJUZ

Q.9

If 26 January 2019 was Saturday, then what was the day of the week on 30 January 2022?

(A) Monday
(B) Sunday
(C) Tuesday
(D) Saturday

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. ACCURATE : RATEACCU :: ANALYSIS : YSISANAL :: CAPACITY : ?

(A) CITYPACA
(B) YTICAPAC
(C) CITYCAPA
(D) PACACITY

Q.11

In a certain code language, "ABROAD" is written as "BDUNYA", and "BECAME" is written as "CGFZKB". How will "CANCER" be written in that language?

(A) DQCBCO
(B) DCQOBC
(C) DCQCBO
(D) DCQBCO

Q.12

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 13, 26, 23, ?, 87, 522

(A) 95
(B) 94
(C) 90
(D) 92

Q.13

Select the option that represents the letters that, when sequentially placed from left to right in the blanks below, will complete the letter series. t _ r a s _ t _ s _ a _ _ _ t _ r _ s r t

(A) s r t r a r t s a
(B) s r a r s r t s a
(C) s r t r s r t s t
(D) s r t r s r t s a

Q.14

If P denotes '×', Q denotes '÷', R denotes '+' and S denotes '–', then what will come in place of '?' in the following equation? 130 S 61 R (23 P 4) S 83 R (62 Q 2) = ?

(A) 120
(B) 109
(C) 115
(D) 104

Q.15

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row: 187, 164, 141 Second row: 215, 192, 169 Third row: 178, 155, ? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the number into its constituent digits. For example, 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 129
(B) 131
(C) 123
(D) 132

Q.17

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs, except one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 100 : 81
(B) 36 : 16
(C) 49 : 25
(D) 81 : 49

Q.18

Which two numbers, from amongst the given options, should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? (40×6) ÷8 + 14 – (7×16) + (13×12) =26

(A) 40 and 16
(B) 8 and 12
(C) 6 and 12
(D) 14 and 16

Q.19

Which number will replace the question mark (?) in the following series? 6, 12, 20, 30, ?, 56

(A) 42
(B) 25
(C) 49
(D) 36

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'CHECK' is written as '6165622' and 'SURGE' is written as '382136145'. How will 'PRIEST' be written in that language?

(A) 32369538
(B) 1618101920
(C) 161818101920
(D) 3236953840

Q.24

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 19, 37, 74, 147, 294, ?

(A) 578
(B) 587
(C) 577
(D) 588

Quantitative Aptitude 12 questions

Q.1

By selling a fridge for ₹18,200, Anu loses 15%. Find the cost price of the fridge. (Consider integral part only)

(A) ₹21,820
(B) ₹21,411
(C) ₹19,680
(D) ₹19,411

Q.2

The marked price of a mobile phone is ₹18,000. It is sold with two successive discounts of 25% and 4%. An additional discount of 5% is offered for cash payment. The selling price of the mobile on cash payment is:

(A) ₹12,312
(B) ₹12,123
(C) ₹12,132
(D) ₹12,231

Q.3

In still water, the speed of a motorboat is 15 km/h. The boat travels 30 km downstream and returns in 4 hours and 30 minutes. The stream's speed (in km/h) is:

(A) 4
(B) 7
(C) 5
(D) 3

Q.5

A cot was marked for ₹15,000 but sold for ₹13,500. What was the discount percentage offered on it?

(A) 20%
(B) 15%
(C) 10%
(D) 12%

Q.6

Two years ago, the population of a village was 1,000. The population increased by 10% is the first year and decreased by 10% in the second year. Find the present population.

(A) 985
(B) 980
(C) 990
(D) 995

Q.10

As part of Diwali offer, a jeweller allows a discount of 15%. Even after giving the discount, he makes a profit of 6.25%. Rani bought a gold chain which was marked at ₹5,000 from this jeweller. Find the cost price of the chain for the jeweller.

(A) ₹5,000
(B) ₹4,400
(C) ₹3,400
(D) ₹4,000

Q.11

The average weight of 18 boys in a class is 45 kg and that of the remaining 8 boys is 48.75 kg. Find the average weight (in kg) of all the boys in the class.(Correct to two decimal places)

(A) 47.5
(B) 44.98
(C) 46.15
(D) 42

Q.13

If 5 persons can prepare 5 tables in 5 days, then how long will it take 25 persons to prepare 25 tables?

(A) 25 days
(B) 15 days
(C) 20 days
(D) 5 days

Q.15

The average weight of a family of 4 members is 45 kg. The grandfather and the grandmother come to visit the family. Now the average weight of the 6 members of the family is 48 kg. Find the average weight of the grandparents (in kg).

(A) 53
(B) 52
(C) 51
(D) 54

Q.16
A chord of 10 cm passes through the centre of a circle. What is the diameter of the circle?

(A) 5 cm
(B) 15 cm
(C) 20 cm
(D) 10 cm

Q.21
The diameter of a solid hemisphere is 10 cm. Find its total surface area (use π=3.14).

(A) 288 cm^2
(B) 265.8 cm^2
(C) 235.5 cm^2
(D) 245 cm^2

Q.22
A cone-shaped temple top has slant height of 10 m and radius of base is 11 m. Find the total cost for painting its curved surface area at the rate of ₹7/m^2. [Use π=22/7]

(A) ₹2,440
(B) ₹2,040
(C) ₹2,420
(D) ₹2,240

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
Surendranath Banerjee's autobiography is called _____.

(A) Hind Swaraj
(B) A Nation in the Making
(C) Young India
(D) Hints for Self Culture

Q.2
Who termed Article 32 as the 'heart and soul of the Constitution of India'?

(A) MV Pylee
(B) BR Ambedkar
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) Sachchidananda Sinha

Q.3
Which phylum of the Kingdom Animalia includes animals such as Hydra, Adamsia, Physalia and Corals?

(A) Coelenterata
(B) Platyhelminthes
(C) Annelida
(D) Porifera

Q.4
Payment of loan by the government is an example of _____.

(A) revenue expenditure
(B) revenue receipts
(C) capital receipts
(D) capital expenditure

Q.5
Which of the following pairs is NOT correctly matched?

(A) Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia – Bamboo flute
(B) Miyan Tansen – One of the nine jewels
(C) Ustad Ali Akbar Khan – Sarode
(D) Ustad Bismillah Khan – Sitar

Q.6
At the December 2021 BWF World Tour Finals in Bali, Indonesia, shuttler _____ clinched the silver medal.

(A) Aakarshi Kashyap
(B) Mugdha Agrey
(C) Saina Nehwal
(D) PV Sindhu

Q.7
Pandit Sunder Prasad who was awarded with the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1959 was a _____ dancer.

(A) Kathakali
(B) Odissi
(C) Kathak
(D) Mohiniyattam

Q.8
Which of the following states present Kalidas Samman annually?

(A) Chhattisgarh
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Andhra Pradesh

Q.9
Totaram Sharma is an exponent of _____.

(A) flute
(B) nadaswaran
(C) ghatam
(D) pakhawaj

Q.10
The 10th Women's Hockey Asia Cup was held at _____.

(A) India
(B) Bahrain
(C) Qatar
(D) Muscat

Q.11
In April 2021, Nethra Kumanan became the first Indian woman ever to qualify for the Olympics in _____.

(A) modern pentathlon
(B) Alpine skiing
(C) sailing
(D) fencing

Q.12
Who among the following won the first National Film Award for Best Choreography in 1992?

(A) Saroj Khan
(B) Laxmibai Kolhapurkar
(C) Vaibhavi Merchant
(D) Shiamak Davar

Q.13
BS Yediyurappa resigned as the Chief Minister of Karnataka for the _____ time in July 2021.

(A) second
(B) third
(C) fifth
(D) fourth

Q.14
From which of the following years was the National Kalidas Samman started in India?

(A) 1989
(B) 1992
(C) 1984
(D) 1980

Q.15
The famous novel ‘Ananda Math’ was originally written in _____ language.

(A) Bengali
(B) Hindi
(C) Sanskrit
(D) Odia

Q.16
Who among the following was the first Indian musician conferred with the Ramon Magsaysay Award and also the first Indian to have performed in United Nations General Assembly in 1966?

(A) Gagubai Hangal
(B) Vansundhara Komkali
(C) Lata Mangeshkar
(D) M S Subbulakshmi

Q.17
Which enzyme is responsible for the oxidation reaction that occurs in some foods, mostly fruits and vegetables, that turns the food brown?

(A) Polyphenol oxidase
(B) Bromelain
(C) Serrapeptase
(D) Papain

Q.18
Which is the fourth largest water body in the world recognised by the US Board on Geographic Names as a body of water extending off the coast of Antarctica?

(A) Southern Ocean
(B) Indian Ocean
(C) Arctic Ocean
(D) Atlantic Ocean

Q.19
Who among the following is the author of the book 'The Inheritance of Loss'?

(A) Arundhati Roy
(B) Sudha Murty
(C) Kiran Desai
(D) Jhumpa Lahiri

Q.20
Which water body is adjacent to the Atlantic Ocean, located in the southeast of the Gulf of Mexico?

(A) Arabian Sea
(B) Baltic Sea
(C) Caspian Sea
(D) Caribbean Sea

Q.21
Who among the following was given the title of Mallika-e-Ghazal?

(A) Begum Akhtar
(B) Iqbal Bano
(C) Nayyara Noor
(D) Farida Khanum

Q.22
Which of the following minerals' primary constituent is iron oxide containing equal amounts of iron (II) and iron (III) that is mainly used for steel manufacturing?

(A) Magnetite
(B) Mica
(C) Limestone
(D) Bauxite

Q.23
Identify the component found only in a eukaryotic cell.

(A) Ribosomes
(B) Plasma membrane
(C) Nuclear membrane
(D) Cytoplasm

Q.24
Which of the following pairs are NOT correctly matched? I.13th ICC One Day Cricket World Cup - India II.12th ICC Women's one day Cricket World Cup - New Zealand III.8th T20 Women's Cricket World Cup - South Africa IV.8th T20 Men's Cricket World Cup – India

(A) IV
(B) I
(C) II
(D) III

Q.25
When is the approximate arrival of the Arabian Sea branch of monsoon in Mumbai?

(A) March 10
(B) August 10
(C) June 10
(D) September 10

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**
Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**
Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (D) write her

After 'will be' the verb takes the -ing form: 'She will be writing her examination by this time tomorrow.'

Q.2 · Answer (D) Polemical

'Polemical' means relating to controversy or heated argument. 'Laudatory' means praising, and 'putative' means supposed.

Q.3 · Answer (C) on

Resting on top of a surface takes 'on': the children sat on the tables instead of on the chairs.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Luminary

A luminary is a person who inspires or enlightens others. A luminaire is a light fitting, and a lunette a crescent-shaped window or space.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Polite

'Impudent' means rudely disrespectful; its opposite is 'polite'. 'Insolent' is a synonym.

Q.6 · Answer (A) calm

'Tranquil' means peaceful and still: 'calm'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Whipe

'Whipe' is misspelt: the word is 'wipe'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Wisedom

The correct spelling is 'wisdom': 'wise' drops its 'e' before '-dom'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) sea

We go to the 'sea'; 'see' sounds the same but is a verb.

Q.10 · Answer (A) To express loyalty, respect, or support for something insincerely

To 'pay lip service' to something is to express support for it in words without really meaning it.

Q.11 · Answer (B) but Rhea is better

Comparing two people takes the comparative degree: 'Rhea is better'. 'The best' is for three or more.

Q.12 · Answer (A) In the theatre, flowers were thrown by the audience.

The simple past 'threw' becomes 'were thrown', plural to agree with 'flowers'. (Every option leaves out 'on the screen'.)

Q.13 · Answer (C) necessary

The correct spelling is 'necessary': one 'c' and a double 's'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Contemporaries

Contemporaries are people who live or work in the same period.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Foolish

'Judicious' means showing good judgement; its opposite is 'foolish'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Everyone has good luck or success at a point of time

'Every dog has his day' means that everyone gets a spell of good luck or success at some time.

Q.18 · Answer (D) stalked, tendrils, concealment

He 'stalked' (approached stealthily) the tree, kept clear of the creepers whose upper 'tendrils' might have been seen, and sat in perfect 'concealment' from the tiger.

Q.19 · Answer (A) To happen

'Come about' means to happen: 'How did this come about?'

Q.20 · Answer (A) ACBD
A introduces the love story, C begins it with Khurram first seeing Arjumand in 1607, B says who she was, and D tells of their marriage: ACBD.

Q.21 · Answer (A) value
The 'value' that comes out of the story is its lesson, the worth of hard work. ('Morals' is plural and does not agree with 'comes'.)

Q.22 · Answer (A) that
'In such a way that' introduces the result: they realise the worth of hard work.

Q.23 · Answer (D) negative
Laziness is a 'negative' trait, set against the 'positive note' of hard work later in the sentence.

Q.24 · Answer (D) while
'While' joins two things done together: discouraging laziness while emphasising hard work.

Q.25 · Answer (A) positive
Hard work is the 'positive' note, in contrast with the negative trait of laziness.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (D) ÷,–,+,×, =
25 ÷ 5 – 10 + 2 × 4 = 5 – 10 + 8 = 3.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 15 : 3150
The second number is $n^2 \times (n + 1)$: $7^2 \times 8 = 392$, $9^2 \times 10 = 810$ and $12^2 \times 13 = 1{,}872$. But $15^2 \times 16 = 3{,}600$, not 3,150.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Only conclusions I and II follow
All apples and all grapes are bananas, and all bananas are nuts, so all apples and all grapes are nuts (I and II). Some nuts are bananas, so III does not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (A) ZCFI
First letters run X, Y, Z, A, B; second letters move +2 (Y, A, C, E, G); third letters +3 (Z, C, F, I, L); fourth letters +4 (A, E, I, M, Q). The missing cluster is ZCFI.

Q.7 · Answer (D) VOJWFSTJUZ
Each letter moves one place forward: SCHOOL → TDIPPM and COLLEGE → DPMMFHF. So UNIVERSITY → VOJWFSTJUZ.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Sunday
From 26 January 2019 to 26 January 2022 is 3 years with one leap day (29 February 2020): 4 odd days, so 26 January 2022 was a Wednesday. Four days later, 30 January, was a Sunday.

Q.10 · Answer (C) CITYCAPA
The last four letters move to the front: ACCU RATE → RATEACCU and ANAL YSIS → YSISANAL. So CAPA CITY → CITYCAPA.

Q.11 · Answer (D) DCQBCO
The letters move +1, +2, +3, –1, –2, –3: ABROAD → BDUNYA and BECAME → CGFZKB. So CANCER → DCQBCO.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 92
The steps are ×2, –3, ×4, –5, ×6: 13 × 2 = 26, 26 – 3 = 23, 23 × 4 = 92, 92 – 5 = 87 and 87 × 6 = 522.

Q.13 · Answer (D) s r t r s r t s a
With s, r, t, r, s, r, t, s, a in the blanks the block tsrasrt repeats: tsrasrt tsrasrt tsrasrt.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 109
130 – 61 + (23 × 4) – 83 + (62 ÷ 2) = 130 – 61 + 92 – 83 + 31 = 109.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 132
In each row every number is 23 less than the one before: 187, 164, 141 and 215, 192, 169. So 155 – 23 = 132.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 100 : 81
The second number is the square of two less than the first's square root: 36 → $(6 - 2)^2 = 16$, 49 → $5^2 = 25$ and 81 → $7^2 = 49$. But 100 → $8^2 = 64$, not 81.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 8 and 12
Interchanging 8 and 12: (40 × 6) ÷ 12 + 14 – (7 × 16) + (13 × 8) = 20 + 14 – 112 + 104 = 26.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 42
The terms are n(n + 1): 2 × 3, 3 × 4, 4 × 5, 5 × 6, then 6 × 7 = 42 and 7 × 8 = 56.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 3236953840
Each consonant is written as twice its place in the alphabet and each vowel as its place: CHECK → 6 16 5 6 22 and SURGE → 38 21 36 14 5. So PRIEST → 32 36 9 5 38 40.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 587
The steps alternate ×2 – 1 and ×2: 19 → 37 → 74 → 147 → 294, and 294 × 2 – 1 = 587.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (B) ₹21,411
₹18,200 is 85% of the cost price: 18,200/0.85 = ₹21,411.76, whose integral part is ₹21,411.

Q.2 · Answer (A) ₹12,312
₹18,000 × 0.75 × 0.96 × 0.95 = ₹12,312.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 5
With stream speed s: 30/(15 + s) + 30/(15 – s) = 4.5, so 900/($225 - s^2$) = 4.5, $225 - s^2 = 200$ and s = 5.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 10%
The discount is ₹1,500 on a marked price of ₹15,000: 1,500/15,000 = 10%.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 990
1,000 × 1.1 × 0.9 = 990.

Q.10 · Answer (D) ₹4,000
Selling price = ₹5,000 × 0.85 = ₹4,250, which is 106.25% of the cost: 4,250/1.0625 = ₹4,000.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 46.15
(18 × 45 + 8 × 48.75)/26 = (810 + 390)/26 = 1,200/26 = 46.15 kg.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 5 days
Each person makes one table in 5 days, so 25 persons make 25 tables in the same 5 days.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 54
The grandparents weigh 6 × 48 – 4 × 45 = 288 – 180 = 108 kg together: an average of 54 kg.

Q.16 · Answer (D) 10 cm
A chord through the centre is a diameter, so the diameter is 10 cm.

Q.21 · Answer (C) 235.5 cm²
A solid hemisphere's total surface area is $3\pi r^2 = 3 \times 3.14 \times 5^2 = 235.5$ cm².

Q.22 · Answer (C) ₹2,420
Curved surface area = πrl = (22/7) × 11 × 10 = 2,420/7 m²; at ₹7/m² the cost is ₹2,420.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) A Nation in the Making
Surendranath Banerjee's autobiography, published in 1925, is 'A Nation in Making'. 'Hind Swaraj' is Gandhi's book and 'Young India' the weekly he edited; 'Hints for Self Culture' is Lala Har Dayal's.

Q.2 · Answer (B) BR Ambedkar
B. R. Ambedkar called Article 32, the right to constitutional remedies, the very heart and soul of the Constitution.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Coelenterata
Hydra, Adamsia (a sea anemone), Physalia (the Portuguese man-of-war) and corals are coelenterates (cnidarians): radially symmetrical animals with stinging cells.

Q.4 · Answer (D) capital expenditure
Repaying a loan reduces the government's liabilities, so it is capital expenditure; the interest paid on a loan is revenue expenditure.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Ustad Bismillah Khan – Sitar
Ustad Bismillah Khan was the master of the shehnai, not the sitar. Chaurasia plays the bamboo flute, Tansen was one of Akbar's nine jewels and Ali Akbar Khan played the sarod.

Q.6 · Answer (D) PV Sindhu
P. V. Sindhu lost the final of the 2021 BWF World Tour Finals to South Korea's An Se-young and took the silver medal.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Kathak
Pandit Sunder Prasad was a Kathak dancer and guru of the Jaipur gharana.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Madhya Pradesh
The Kalidas Samman is presented by the Government of Madhya Pradesh.

Q.9 · Answer (D) pakhawaj
Pandit Totaram Sharma is known as a master of the pakhawaj, the barrel-shaped drum that accompanies dhrupad.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Muscat
The 10th Women's Hockey Asia Cup was held in Muscat, Oman, in January 2022.

Q.11 · Answer (C) sailing
Nethra Kumanan qualified in the Laser Radial class at the Mussanah Open in Oman in April 2021, the first Indian woman sailor to reach the Olympics.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Laxmibai Kolhapurkar
Laxmibai Kolhapurkar won the first National Film Award for Best Choreography, at the 40th National Film Awards (for 1992), for the Marathi film 'Ek Hota Vidushak'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) fourth
B. S. Yediyurappa became Chief Minister four times (2007, 2008, 2018 and 2019), and his resignation on 26 July 2021 ended the fourth term.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 1980
The Government of Madhya Pradesh instituted the Kalidas Samman in 1980.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Bengali
Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay wrote 'Anandamath' (1882) in Bengali; 'Vande Mataram' appears in it.

Q.16 · Answer (D) M S Subbulakshmi
M. S. Subbulakshmi sang at the UN General Assembly in 1966 and in 1974 became the first Indian musician to receive the Ramon Magsaysay Award.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Polyphenol oxidase
Polyphenol oxidase oxidises phenolic compounds in cut fruit and vegetables, turning them brown. Bromelain and papain break down proteins.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Southern Ocean
The US Board on Geographic Names recognised the Southern Ocean, around Antarctica, in 1999; it is the fourth largest of the five oceans.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Kiran Desai
Kiran Desai's 'The Inheritance of Loss' won the Booker Prize in 2006.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Caribbean Sea
The Caribbean Sea, an arm of the Atlantic bounded by Central America and the West Indies, lies south-east of the Gulf of Mexico.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Begum Akhtar
Begum Akhtar, the great ghazal singer, is remembered as 'Mallika-e-Ghazal', the queen of ghazals.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Magnetite
Magnetite, Fe_3O_4 ($FeO{\cdot}Fe_2O_3$), is an iron oxide holding iron(II) and iron(III) in the ratio 1:2, and a rich ore of iron for steelmaking. Mica, limestone and bauxite are not iron ores.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Nuclear membrane
Only eukaryotic cells have a nucleus bounded by a nuclear membrane. Ribosomes, a plasma membrane and cytoplasm are found in prokaryotic cells too.

Q.24 · Answer (A) IV
The 8th ICC Men's T20 World Cup (2022) was held in Australia, not India. India hosted the 13th Men's ODI World Cup (2023), New Zealand the 12th Women's ODI World Cup (2022) and South Africa the 8th Women's T20 World Cup (2023).

Q.25 · Answer (C) June 10
By NCERT's account the Arabian Sea branch of the monsoon reaches Mumbai about ten days after Kerala, around 10 June.

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